Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From an interview with Elizabeth Eckford, one of the Little Rock Nine, recalling her experience on 4 September 1957.

I walked up to the guard who had let the white students in. When I tried to pass, he raised his bayonet and then the other guards closed in. They did not let me pass. The crowd began to follow me, screaming, 'Lynch her! Lynch her!' I looked for a friendly face, but everyone was hostile. I finally made it to the bus stop and just sat there crying. It was the most terrifying day of my life.

Source C

Source C: From a radio address by President Dwight D. Eisenhower to the American people, 24 September 1957.

Mob rule in Little Rock cannot be allowed to override the decisions of our courts. I have sent units of the 101st Airborne Division to Little Rock and have federalised the Arkansas National Guard. We are a nation where laws, not violence, must govern. The integration of Central High School must proceed in an orderly fashion, and the safety of the nine students must be guaranteed by the federal government.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
The Little Rock crisis was a huge victory for the civil rights movement. By sending in the 101st Airborne Division, President Eisenhower showed that the federal government was willing to use military force to enforce desegregation. It proved to Southern governors that they could not simply ignore the Supreme Court's rulings, giving civil rights activists a massive boost.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
The events at Little Rock showed the severe limitations of federal intervention. Central High School was only integrated because soldiers with bayonets protected the Black students daily. The following year, Governor Faubus closed all Little Rock high schools to prevent further integration. The crisis actually slowed down the pace of integration across the Deep South as white resistance hardened.

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